

CANONICAL LESSON

Earlier Signals, Safer Escalation

Decision-centred foundations for accountable sector intelligence

Production Unit	PU-B07-C14
Notebook	V7_A_N09
Status	Controlled educational draft v0.1
Data boundary	Synthetic instructional data only

Central decision: Combine crop-risk and food-security signals into an early-warning workflow with severity, persistence, corroboration, capacity, and escalation controls.

Learning outcomes

Why this matters

Early-warning systems can generate harmful false alarms or dangerous silence when thresholds and escalation duties are unclear.

The analytical workflow is useful only when evidence, uncertainty, authority, and action are connected explicitly. The model supports professional judgement; it does not replace accountable institutional authority.

Worked cross-sector example

A persistent multi-source risk signal triggers a time-bound analyst review rather than an automatic food-security classification.

Boundary: The example supports learning and review. It does not constitute an official statistic, eligibility determination, enforcement action, clinical judgement, or operational authorization.

Practice and reflection

- 1.
- Add conflict/access constraints.
- 2.
- Explain why indicators should not be averaged blindly.
- 3.

- Design an escalation protocol.

Answer key

- 1.
- Add a dated, sourced accessibility field and abstain where observation is unsafe.
- 2.
- Scales and meanings differ; aggregation requires explicit normalization, weights, and sensitivity.
- 3.
- Specify verification owner, deadline, corroboration, action authority, communication, and closure criteria.

Operational readiness checklist

- Purpose and decision owner are named.
- Evidence definitions, provenance, and lawful access are documented.
- Uncertainty and abstention are visible.
- Human review, escalation, monitoring, incident response, and retirement are assigned.
- Equity, accessibility, security, and sector-specific approval are complete.